

place such a huge amount of money on a game that didn't have any popularity in the country, lucky for them, Valorant had gained a huge player base in the country due to the ban of the biggest e-sports title in India at that time, PUBG Mobile. The ban had resulted in streamers scrambling for other games to play and seeing people of international calibre playing a brand new game built by the developers of the global phenomenon known to us as League of Legends. It didn't take them long to follow suit and hop onto the Valorant train. Die hard fans of the streamers who still watched them despite the game they grew on getting banned, soon joined them in playing the game itself, and given the sweaty tryhards PUBGM had made them, they were quick in climbing the ranks from Iron to Diamond or Immortal or even Radiant. Seeing the huge growth of the game, Nodwin was quick in building the first ever big tournament for the country and took advantage of the huge player base that had just been built. We saw players from all ranks join the tournament, from Irons who got thrashed in the Round of 64 itself, to Immortals and Radiants who took the fight ahead and made it to the finals. This was the time Velocity started showing that they were a



team to be reckoned with as even Reckoning eSports themselves couldn't beat them in the Finals of the tournament.

In a somewhat unconventional way, various different streaming platforms that were made in India itself also helped in growing the esports market by sponsoring various events and having them streamed on their platform. Apps/ Websites such as Loco and Rooter, which are now names known to every gamer, are slowly and steadily growing their user base and attract-



ing more and more streamers, especially people from the Indian Sub-Continent. These are people who are looking to get into content creation and maybe turn it into a profession for themselves.

Not only did these streaming platforms give them a place to start their career off, but with the incentives they offer to their streamers, it makes streaming on them a very viable option for anyone looking to make a name for themselves.

While we are on content creators, let's give them credits where it is due. Obviously, Valorant wouldn't be what it is today if not for the Raze Double Satchels shown off by Flights, or the most unpredictable omen teleports performed by none other than the Omen King, Flexinja. And of course, the guy who makes you want to AWP in valorant every single day, Wardell.

It was due to the creativity of content creators such as them that Valorant gained the name that they have. Not to mention the support that they received from Riot Games themselves was only one of the

many incentives for them to keep making content around the game.

WHAT IT IS TODAY

Today, we see a few teams being called the Titans of India. Namely Global eSports and the aforementioned Velocity Gaming. Though they might be the behemoths of the Indian scene today, other teams have made it evident that they are looking for just one slip-up from the titans and they'll be quick in dethroning them.

Teams like Enigma Gaming and God Particles have shown this attitude in the previous VCC Qualifiers where Enigma Gaming were successful in beating Global eSports and winning the first qualifiers and securing a spot in the next qualifiers



and God Particles came really close by winning the first map and taking it to double overtime in the next. Even though they were unable to win the match in the end, they were the ones who came out as the fan favourites as this was a team which did not have an org behind them.

Global eSports had been able to qualify for the VCT APAC Last Chance qualifier the last time around as well and they did not lack on the efforts to make sure they and